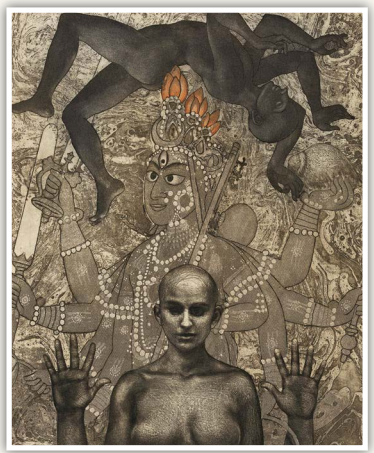
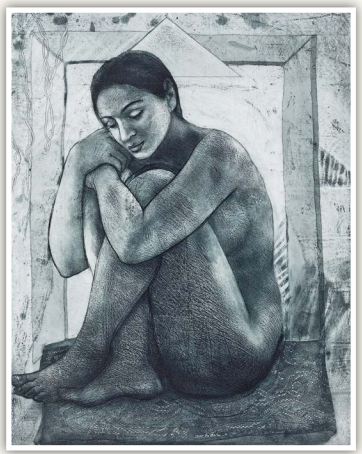
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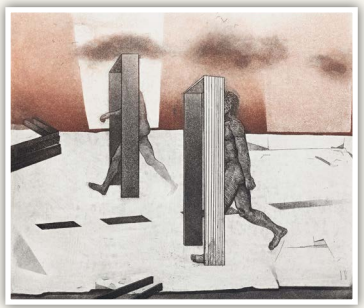
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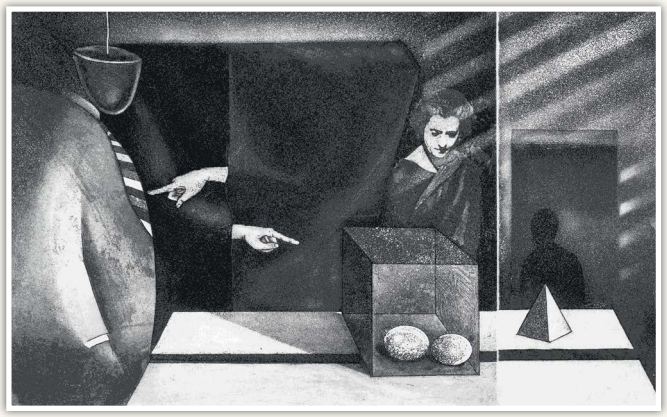
Veteran printmaker **Anupam Sud**'s solo show at Delhi's Palette Art Gallery showcases a half-century of relentless experimentation





ART UNBOUND
Clockwise from above, 'Cosmic dancer', "Enfold', 'Hatching', 'Morning Walk'





An exhibition in the capital traces the illustrious five-decade-long artistic journey of one of India's most celebrated contemporary artists. The comprehensive showcase features over 60 works by Delhi-based printmaker Anupam Sud, from her early etchings crafted in the 1970s to her sculptural forms as well as her recent experimental print collages created during the pandemic.

Sud's pioneering contributions to etching and printmaking stand as a testament to her technical brilliance and relentless experimentation. The exhibition, spanning two distinct periods of her practice–the early 1970s and the more recent 2010s–showcases the evolution of an artist who has continuously challenged conventions over the years. "It is a time to reflect on how the concerns of an urban society, as experienced by me and manifested in my printmaking, have changed over time," says Sud.

Sud's pioneering contributions to etching and printmaking stand as a testament to her technical brilliance

Sud's early years were spent in Shimla where she was educated. The Bengal School of Art greatly influenced her during her childhood. Later, when her family moved to Delhi, her father took her to the National Gallery of Modern Art, where she was inspired by Amrita Sher-Gil's western style of art. "Even though I wanted to be an artist, I was disappointed when I didn't get admission to an art college. Instead, I entered into a bachelor's degree in mathematics. However, the next year, I got through the College of Art, New Delhi. Thereafter, I learnt what art is," she reminisces.

Sud went on to win a scholarship to the Slade School of Art, London, where she mastered the art of traditional printmaking techniques using metal plates. She also became an active member of Jagmohan Chopra's Group 8. At the age of 23, she debuted with a solo exhibition at Triveni Kala Sangam, Delhi, in 1967. A prominent feature of her practice is human figures–both male and female. Gradually, the female perspective, primarily due to the female protagonists in her work, became critical to Sud's practice.

The rigours of printmaking, involving exposing one's hands to water and acid, are too physically arduous for the octogenarian artist now. Thus currently, she is working on oil paintings. "Otherwise, I am always scribbling something or the other in my sketchbook," she says. ■

–Neha Kirpal
Anupam Sud: The Journey A Full Circle ***will run at Palette Art Gallery till Feb. 7***